

restore a car. "Importing all the spare parts is a task as you have to search for them globally through various vendors and clubs," he says. "It's a challenge but one that any vintage car enthusiast really enjoys. You invest your time and energy in it and then when the car is fully restored and you hear praise for it from other collectors, it's a big high."

Restoring the car is taxing as you cannot innovate. If a piece is not available it's not as if you can use a replacement. You have to create the piece with the same specifications. "There is something called the 100 Point Restoration and it includes both the exterior and interiors of the car along with the mechanicals," explains Mohan. For instance, you cannot use metallic paint if it was not invented when the car was first launched, or use chrome finish on what was originally nickel. So effectively you have to do a lot of research on what the original car was like.

From an investment point of view, the rarer the car, the better. Mohan says nearly 88 brands don't exist anymore so if you have a car in good condition from one of those brands, the value is higher. But then restoring them is also that much more difficult.

Even from the existing brands, it's best to invest in a rarer model. Mohan suggests the Rolls-Royce Silver Ghost models from 1907 to 1915. Similarly the Phantom from 1925-28 carries a better price. "The Rolls-Royce Phantom was available a decade ago for ₹50 lakh. Today it sells at auction for ₹4 crore," says Mohan.

Mohan started collecting cars in 2000. "There were cars that I did not buy because of a differ-



PER THE KNIGHT FRANK LUXURY INVESTMENT INDEX, THE ASSET VALUE OF CLASSIC CARS APPRECIATED BY 25 PER CENT YEAR-ON-YEAR IN 2022

